

The Fifty Verses on Kulalokanātha

Kulalokanātha Pañcadaśaka · Toh 436 · Derge Kangyur

རགས་ཀ་ཁྱིའི་རྩེ་མགོ་པ་ལོ་བཅུ་ཞེས་བ་དུ།

Toh 436 in the Kangyur is a tantric text known in Sanskrit as the Kulalokanātha Pañcadaśaka and in Tibetan as Rigs kyi 'jig rten mgon po lnga bcu pa, rendered in English as "The Fifty Verses on the Protector of the World of the Noble Clan." It belongs to the class of tantric literature and concerns the esoteric teachings surrounding Kulalokanātha, a deity associated with the noble clan, presenting instruction on sacred commitments, mantra, and the nature of the genuine deity through verse. The text opens with a homage to the Protector of the World of the Noble Clan and proceeds to expound non-dual mantra teachings framed as supremely secret doctrine. It was translated into Tibetan by the translator Gyico Dawé Özer and sits within the tantric section of the Kangyur.

The tantra of Rāsi was translated, edited, and definitively established by the translator Gyico Dawé Özer.

In the language of India: Kulalokanātha Pañcadaśaka nāma. In the language of Tibet: The text known as "The Fifty Verses on the Protector of the World of the Noble Clan."

Homage to the glorious Protector of the World of the Noble Clan.

Now this, which is supremely secret,
the highest of true worldly bewilderment —
by declaring the clan and what arises from the clan,
the non-dual mantra shall be fully expounded.

One who practices the sacred commitment is definitively liberated.
Activities and fixed times are entirely abandoned.
The genuine deity endowed with those three realities,
the Protector of the World, the lord of beings —
the lord of desire, the deity of desire —
bestows the supreme fruit, both seen and unseen.

Here the mantra, which is without equal,
abides perfectly on the lips of the guru.
Upon the body of the Greatly Fierce, the Terrifying One,
together with the bindu of the fifth —
endowed with the first full separation,

adorned by the fifth of the five great ones —
two tongues dwell where two limbs are absent.
Through the three bodies, the supreme mantra,
drawn from the collection of syllables,
is recited according to the defining ritual.

A mantra practitioner who recollects this —
whether pure or impure —
is seen by the gods as if a god,
and the goddess of that deity, like a god of desire.
For one who recites the mantra of desire in this manner,
there is no ritual activity, no accomplishment to be performed,
no offering, no fire, no fire-oblation.

One endowed with yoga, one who is authentic,
definitively liberated from all fixed times —
with a one-pointed mind that does not waver,
free from obscuration, applying the supreme meditative concentration of
sameness,
one who is wise establishes this firmly.

For all beings of hostile nature,
accomplishment on the earth's surface, beneath the earth, and in the higher
realms:

in the great lotus of the navel center,
the triple space enters within.

Endowed with the lotus mudrā,
like the essential nature of the sky-mudrā,
with the measure of descending life-breath,
the two abodes are to be familiarized.

Having thus established it with full clarity,
one becomes the very form of the Protector of the World.

Whoever recites it elsewhere
and performs those activities:

that is like gathering fistfuls of sky —

by bewilderment, one destroys a thousand kindred.

Through the application of meditative concentration according to the ritual,
whatever activity is always to be performed —

that is accomplished swiftly.

The activity of that one is desired by the mind.

This has been the first chapter, the chapter on the suchness of the mantra, from "The Fifty Contemplations of Kulalokanātha, the Lord of the World of the Noble Clan."

One's own intrinsic nature, endowed with meditative concentration,

like the rays of nutmeg and cinnabar —

like pomegranate seeds, like aged grain, like flowers —

the chief, resembling red lac,

deity of deities in the body of mantra,

with one face and four hands,

seated upon a lotus-moon-sky throne,

the all-pervading one holding a lasso and a hook.

With the hand of supreme giving, one plays in fullness.

Adorned with pearls and gems,

with a lotus hand and three eyes,

a body of great splendor and varied form —

the Hero, the Sovereign, Protector of beings,

who delights the heart of the yoginī,

who supremely bestows all accomplishments —

upon all those mantras one meditates.

Through whatever meditation one cultivates —

Through yoga becoming habituated,

one comes to take on that very nature —

just as the supreme wish-fulfilling jewel.

The white deity bestows supreme peace.

Likewise, speech effects the awakening.

For the suchness of enchantment and hooking,

visualize the form as vividly red,

bearing the color and light of red smoke,

wrapped in a maṇḍala of wind —

this drives enemies swiftly away.

Here there is no doubt about this.

With smoke that is grey-red,

one applies definite aversion.

For killing, the color is black;
for stupefying, yellow is auspicious.
For one abiding upon a sheep,
when one breathes into the joints,
throughout all three states of existence,
wherever they may be, all are utterly confused.
What need is there of confusion by another?

Words that are a great gathering of many meanings,
the actions of the three worlds —
endowed with eight qualities,
suited for other tantras —
whether spoken or unspoken,
through the application of intrinsic meditative concentration,
there is no doubt about this practice.

Whatever deity resembles space,
distinguished by differences of color,
all the actions performed throughout the three worlds —
these are to be accomplished.

The mantras that create good fortune
pass through the lotus at the center of the heart.
Through the application of the heart's lotus,
one accomplishes perfectly empowerment and the rest.

The deity possessing the three syllables,
endowed with three movements upward,
accomplishing constantly the work among human beings,
dwells at the mouth of the yoginīs.

In three aspects one performs the hooking.
Beautiful, adorned with lotus form —
through the yogi's constant and uninterrupted application,
like a flame that does not waver —

the previously described deity of deities, the lord,
with light resembling the red of dawn,
at the time of the middle of the night,
the yogi should engage in genuine practice.

With the body of that one's form held
truly placed before oneself,
the deity holding lasso and hook —
one truly takes that into the body of the one to be accomplished.
All reside at the mouth of the guru.
Through the rays of light of lasso and hook,
one drives in the hook,
then draws in with the lasso.

Utterly intoxicated, the body flushed red,
fainting again and again —
piercing through the nine orifices,
blood flows forth abundantly.

As though without obscuration,
one should observe one's own body clearly.
The mantra arising from that one's breath —
visualize first as the master of syllables,
blazing and blazing like a flame,
playing before the gateway of the mouth.
That lotus-formed one as well
certainly arises from within the mouth,
dissolves into the mouth of the one to be accomplished,
and for as long as that one's heart-lotus —
whatever dwells in that heart —
here one seizes the entire heart of that one.
Having drawn it in with gentle warmth,
captivating like the form of Tārā —
that one, as the third rite prescribes,
like leaves stirred by the wind,
one meditates progressively in one's own dwelling.

The supreme, having become one in essence —
the deity and the means of accomplishing the deity —
is to be accomplished in front, at nighttime.
One will enter through the nature of a servant,
and as for livelihood and wealth as well,
what need is there to speak of returning to the world on this earth?
This will be accomplished — of this there is no doubt.

The practitioner who is lord of mantra
should not apply those who lack freedom.
By reciting the supreme victorious king of mantras,
accomplishing royal sovereignty is the supreme attainment.
If one accomplishes it elsewhere through other means,
one becomes intoxicated and blind, as if maddened by desire for women.
If even a divine daughter
comes to that one in that very instant —

This is the third chapter, the chapter on the suchness of the deity, from the
fiftieth section of the Protector of the World of the Lineage.

The supreme essence of the Lord of the World —
guard it truly, hidden like life itself.
Even one of lesser samaya conduct
should recite the mantra as a guide and protector.
Alone, having separated from companions,
the intelligent one should recite it a hundred thousand times.

Direct perception of it will come to pass,
and one proceeds excellently through the three wheels.
Drawing out all the world
and gathering it in, again and again,
one goes with ease to the rank of space —
in mindfulness of this, there is no doubt.

The union of mind and no-mind:
through that, mind is seen in no-mind.
Mind having dissolved into no-mind,
for those women born into supreme engagement of body,
one who is diseased is made free of disease,
and one free of disease is likewise made diseased.
By the power of the king of mantras,
supreme among those who hold the noose and the iron hook —

Otherwise, it is like a child bewildered by foolishness
who wishes to seize the moon.
Whoever accomplishes activities
while separated from the union of intrinsic nature — that is not supreme.

Whoever, knowing through three-by-three, the three occasions,
recognizes the Protector of the World himself,

will proceed to the rank of the Protector of the World
like the sky freed from clouds.

This concludes the fiftieth section, the Protector of the World of the Lineage,
drawn from the great tantra of the Glorious Blazing Lotus.

From the presence of the great paṇḍita Vimalabhadra, at the urging of
Bodhiratna, Śuddhakīrti Gyaltsen translated this at the glorious Sakya temple
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Translator's Notes

- The attribution line names the translator as Gyico Dawé Özer (Tib. gyi co zla ba'i 'od zer), and the tantra as "Rāsi" (rtsi'i rgyud), which may refer to a rasāyana or alchemical text. The title in Sanskrit, Kulalokanātha Pañcadaśaka, is retained; note that pañcadaśaka means "fifteen" (literally "fifteen-verses"), but the Tibetan title reads lnga bcu pa, "fifty," which is a discrepancy; this may be a scribal error in the Sanskrit title or a different recension.

The passages concerning "two tongues where two limbs are absent," the "bindu of the fifth," "the first full separation," and "the fifth of the five great ones" are dense tantric technical language with no explicit commentary available here; their precise referents belong to the internal yoga and mantra-body system of this specific tantra and cannot be resolved without a lineage commentary.

The final sentence of the translation is incomplete in the source, ending mid-verse with "through whatever meditation one cultivates —," which reflects the text as given.

- The phrase rendered as "three states of existence" translates a term that in context most likely refers to waking, dreaming, and deep sleep, or alternatively the three realms of existence — the ambiguity is real but does not alter the overall sense of the passage.

The line about "nine orifices" refers to the nine bodily orifices in traditional Indian physiological reckoning, used here in a ritual subjugation context.

The closing colophon attribution "from the fiftieth section of the Protector of the World of the Lineage, the third chapter on the suchness of the deity" represents a chapter heading in a tantric scripture; the exact title of the root text is not identified from this passage alone.

- The phrase rendered "three-by-three, the three occasions" reflects the Tibetan "gsum gsum gnas skabs gsum," a compressed tantric formulation likely referring to sets of three (perhaps body, speech, and mind; or beginning, middle, and end) in relation to three temporal occasions or states. The precise referent is context-dependent within the tantra's own commentarial tradition and remains partially opaque without that context.

The passage on "mind and no-mind" and the lines concerning women and disease draw on subtle tantric yogic physiology; the translation preserves the surface grammar without importing interpretations not present in the text.

The colophon breaks off mid-sentence at "the glorious Sakya temple," indicating the passage as given is incomplete.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.